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TOWNSHIP OF MAPLEWOOD, NEW JERSEY

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS • DIVISION OF SOLID WASTE & RECYCLING

Comprehensive Municipal Manual on Recycling, Solid Waste Disposal & Resource Recovery

Official municipal operational standard governing curbside dual-stream recycling, the 359 Boyden Avenue Recycling Depot, bulk drop-off programs, seasonal leaf and forestry cleanups, and the civic sanitation enforcement protocols for illegal dumping, park bins, waste accumulation, and public odor complaints.

Part I: Recycling Operations

Dual-stream curbside sorting matrix, Boyden Ave depot schedules, mixed rigid plastics (MRPs), and biannual bulk drop-offs.

Part II: Public Enforcement

Illegal dumping reporting & investigations (§ 209-14), anti-scavenging rules, and neighborhood waste accumulation abatement.

Part III: Park & Odor 311

Damaged/overflowing park bin repair SLAs, public trash odor sanitization sweeps, and commercial dumpster compliance.

PUBLIC COMPLIANCE & HEALTH NOTICE:
This document establishes the binding municipal standards for waste sorting, resource recovery, and environmental health across the Township of Maplewood. Violations of waste segregation, illegal dumping, or public nuisance codes carry mandatory municipal summonses under Township Code Chapters 209 & 239.

FACILITY LOCATION & OPERATIONS:
Maplewood DPW Headquarters & Recycling Center
359 Boyden Avenue, Maplewood, NJ 07040
Phone: (973) 762-1175 | 311 Service Desk: (555) 311-MAPL
Online Portal: maplewoodnj.gov/government/public-works

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Governing Law: Township Code Ch. 209 (Solid Waste), Ch. 239, Ch. 257
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Chapter 1: The Maplewood DPW Recycling Depot (359 Boyden Ave)

The Township of Maplewood operates a state-of-the-art municipal materials recovery facility at **359 Boyden Avenue**, providing residents with self-sorting recycling depots, bulk waste disposal, seasonal organic amendments, and special material drop-offs.

Facility Operating Schedule

Monday through Friday: 8:00 AM – 3:00 PM
Saturday: 8:00 AM – 12:00 PM (Noon)
Sundays & Municipal Holidays: Strictly CLOSED

All incoming vehicles must check in at the scale house gate before entering unloading lanes. Unloading after gate closure is prohibited.

Mandatory Two-Proof Residency Rule

Access is restricted exclusively to **Maplewood residents**. Commercial haulers and out-of-town vehicles are strictly turned away.

Gate officers enforce mandatory presentation of **two (2) physical forms of Maplewood residency** (e.g., NJ Driver's License plus utility bill, tax receipt, or lease).

FREE MUNICIPAL MULCH & SCREENED LEAF COMPOST

As part of Maplewood's closed-loop sustainability cycle, autumn leaves and cleared branches collected by town crews are processed into organic landscaping amendments. **Double-shredded wood mulch and cured leaf compost are available 100% FREE OF CHARGE to Maplewood residents** at the Boyden Avenue Depot during regular operating hours.

DEPOT ORGANIC AMENDMENT COLLECTION GUIDELINES:
- Self-loading service: Residents must bring their own shovels, containers, buckets, or open pickup trucks.
- Commercial landscapers are strictly barred from loading free municipal compost or mulch for commercial client jobs.
- Bulk municipal deliveries (5-yard minimum) are available for a nominal delivery fee via the DPW dispatch desk.

Chapter 2: The Curbside Dual-Stream Framework & Zone Schedules

Under **Maplewood Township Code Chapter 209**, recycling is mandatory for all residential and commercial properties. Maplewood enforces a **dual-stream source-separation model**. Commingling paper with glass/plastic containers is prohibited and results in rejected bins.

MUNICIPAL RECYCLING ZONE	GEOGRAPHIC BOUNDARIES & NEIGHBORHOOD CORRIDORS	COLLECTION FREQUENCY & DAY
Sections 1 & 2	North Maplewood, Valley Street West, Parker Avenue Corridor, and adjacent historic districts.	**Every Other Monday** (Set out by 7:00 AM)
Sections 3 & 4	Maplewood Village, Memorial Park vicinity, Ridgewood Road, Baker Street, and Tuscan School area.	**Every Other Tuesday** (Set out by 7:00 AM)
Sections 5 & 6	Boyden Heights, South Mountain preserve border, Springfield Avenue Corridor, and East Maplewood.	**Every Other Wednesday** (Set out by 7:00 AM)

Chapter 3: Authoritative Material Sorting Matrix

Rigid contamination thresholds are enforced by collection contractors. Contaminated receptacles are stickered and left at the curb:

STREAM A: Fibers & Clean Paper (Blue Bin)

- **Corrugated Cardboard:** Must be flattened and tied with natural twine into bundles not exceeding 3 ft × 3 ft × 1 ft.
- **Paperboard / Chipboard:** Cereal boxes, pasta boxes, tissue boxes, paper towel tubes (remove liners).
- **Mixed Paper:** Office paper, mail, junk mail, catalogs, paperback books, magazines, envelopes.
- **PROHIBITED:** Greasy pizza boxes, waxed milk cartons, paper coffee cups, metallic gift wrap, paper towels.

STREAM B: Commingled Bottles & Containers

- **Plastic Containers (#1, #2, #5 only):** Milk jugs, water bottles, detergent bottles, clean yogurt tubs. Caps may remain on if rinsed.
- **Glass Bottles & Jars:** Clear, green, and brown beverage bottles and food jars. Must be rinsed clean.
- **Metal Cans:** Aluminum beverage cans, steel/tin soup cans, clean pie tins.
- **STRICTLY BANNED:** Plastic bags of any kind (tanglers), styrofoam, motor oil jugs, window glass, lightbulbs, ceramics.

THE "WHEN IN DOUBT, THROW IT OUT" CONTAMINATION PRINCIPLE:
Placing non-recyclable materials or plastic bags into curbside blue bins contaminates entire truckloads, diverting tons of recyclable commodities into costly landfills. If an item does not bear SPI Resin Code #1, #2, or #5, or contains food grease, dispose of it in standard household trash.

Chapter 4: Mixed Rigid Plastics (MRPs) & Depot Drop-Off

Large, bulky molded plastics cannot be collected curbside due to packer truck compression constraints. Maplewood provides dedicated 40-yard roll-off bins at the Boyden Avenue Depot specifically for **Mixed Rigid Plastics (MRPs)**.

Permitted Rigid Plastics at Depot

- Clean 5-gallon spackle, paint & utility pails (metal handles removed)
- Hard plastic laundry baskets and storage totes/crates
- Molded plastic children's toys, playhouses, and slides
- Plastic patio furniture, lawn chairs, and molded tables
- Clean plastic trash cans, recycling bins, and flower nursery flats

Prohibited Plastic Materials

- Expanded Polystyrene (Styrofoam peanuts/coolers - use foam bin)
- Plastic film, vinyl siding, PVC plumbing pipes, hose reels
- Chemical, hazardous waste, or pesticide containers
- Plastic items containing embedded metal axles or motors

Chapter 5: Biannual Bulk Drop-Off & Seasonal Cleanups

The Township hosts a **Biannual Bulk Drop-Off Event** in the **Spring (April)** and **Fall (October)** on the first and second Saturdays. Residents may haul large oversized household items to the Boyden Avenue Depot for environmentally compliant processing.

Eligible Bulk Items

Mattresses and box springs (clean and dry), upholstered sofas, wooden furniture, dressers, desks, area rugs (rolled and tied, max 6 ft), bicycles, and outdoor metal grills (propane tanks removed).

Strictly Prohibited Construction Debris

ZERO construction & demolition (C&D) debris accepted. Sheetrock/drywall, concrete, brick, tile, asphalt shingles, insulation, and commercial contractor cleanouts are barred under municipal ordinance.

SEASONAL OPERATIONS: 4-ROUND CURBSIDE LEAF VACUUMING & GARDEN RAKE-OUT

• **Fall Curbside Leaf Vacuuming (Oct–Dec):** Four rotating town-wide sweeps. Leaves must be raked into long, neat windrows along the street gutter, placed at least 10 feet from storm drain inlets. **Zero plastic or biodegradable bags permitted in leaf piles.** Gas-powered leaf blowers are strictly prohibited during designated quiet windows under Township By-law 2024-12.
• **Spring Garden Rake-Out (April):** Curbside pickup of brush and garden prunings tied in bundles with twine (max. 4 ft length, branches < 3 inches diameter, max. 50 lbs per bundle).

Chapter 6: Public Waste Enforcement, Illegal Dumping & Accumulation

FAQ: "Someone is illegally dumping waste in my neighborhood. What should I do?"

Illegal dumping—including dumping furniture, demolition rubble, tires, landscape debris, or household trash onto vacant lots, public right-of-ways, or street corners—is a serious municipal offense under **Maplewood Township Code § 209-14**. The Township enforces an active inter-agency investigation protocol:

PROTOCOL STEP / ACTION	OPERATIONAL STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)	ENFORCEMENT AUTHORITY
1. Active Dumping in Progress	If an illegal dump is actively occurring, **immediately call 911 or Police Dispatch at (555) 123-7623**. Note vehicle make/model, license plate, color, contractor decals, and departure direction. **DO NOT confront the perpetrator.**	Maplewood Police Department (Traffic & Patrol Units)
2. Reporting Abandoned Waste	Submit a report via the **311 Citizen Portal** (`maplewoodnj.gov/services/request`) under category *Illegal Dumping / Blight*, or call DPW Dispatch. Provide exact address, cross streets, description of waste, and photos.	DPW Dispatch & Code Enforcement Desk
3. Forensic Debris Search	Before clearing, a sworn Code Enforcement officer or DPW supervisor searches the pile for forensic evidence: addressed mail, shipping labels, invoices, or contractor manifests to identify origin.	Health Division & Code Enforcement Investigators
4. Summonses & Court Fines	Perpetrators face mandatory court appearance. Under Code § 209-14, penalties include **fines up to $2,500.00 per offense**, full restitution for municipal cleanup costs, and possible vehicle seizure.	Maplewood Municipal Court (Judge Presiding)

FAQ: "Garbage has been piling up near my house / neighboring property. Can I submit a complaint?"

YES. Property owners are legally required to maintain sanitary conditions under Township Code § 209-7 and Chapter 239 (Property Standards). Piles of trash create public health hazards, rodent harborage (rats, raccoons), and fire dangers.

How to Submit a Waste Pile Complaint

Submit a ticket on `maplewoodnj.gov/services/request` or call the Code Enforcement Bureau at **(973) 762-8120 Ext. 3300**. Provide the exact property address, location of pile (side yard, front porch, alleyway), duration, and photos showing rat/fly attraction.

48-Hour Abatement Notice & Municipal Liens

An inspector conducts a site visit within **24 business hours**. If substantiated, an official **48-Hour Notice of Violation** is posted. If not abated, town crews clean the site; all expenses plus an administrative fee are placed as a **tax lien against the property**, plus daily $250 court fines.

ANTI-SCAVENGING ORDINANCE (§ 209-11): It is unlawful for unauthorized individuals to scavenge, rummage through, or remove materials from curbside recycling bins. Once placed at the curb, all recyclables become property of the Township of Maplewood. Violators are subject to police summons and fines up to $500.

Chapter 7: Park Receptacles, Broken Bins, Odor Complaints & Dumpsters

FAQ: "There is a broken garbage bin in the park. Can I report it?"

YES. The Maplewood DPW Parks & Forestry Division maintains over 140 public park receptacles and 45 pet waste stations across all 18 municipal parks. Residents are encouraged to report broken, vandalized, tipped, or overflowing bins immediately.

ISSUE TYPE / RECEPTACLE STATUS	REPORTING REQUIREMENTS & INTAKE DETAILS	DPW OPERATIONAL RESPONSE SLA
Broken / Damaged Park Bin	Park name (e.g., *Memorial Park, DeHart Park, Borden Park*), landmark location (e.g., near playground, baseball dugout, tennis courts), nature of damage (missing lid, cracked barrel, broken mounting post).	**24 to 48 Hours:** Receptacle repaired or replaced with new heavy-duty steel slat barrel.
Overflowing Park Garbage Bin	Park name, specific bin location, presence of scattered litter or wildlife intrusion (raccoons, birds). Photo helpful.	**4 Hours:** Weekend and holiday roving parks sweep empties bin and sanitizes perimeter.
Damaged Dog Waste Station	Park or trail name, station number if marked, issue (empty bag dispenser or broken disposal receptacle).	**24 Hours:** Bags restocked and waste container emptied by park maintenance.

FAQ: "There is a bad smell coming from a public garbage area. Can I report it?"

YES. Severe odors from public trash cans, street receptacles, or municipal depot areas indicate decomposing organic matter, maggots, or stagnant liquid runoff posing a public health nuisance under Health Code § 142.

How Odor Complaints are Handled

Submit ticket under *311 Public Sanitation / Odor & Health Hazard*. The DPW washes down the receptacle within **24 hours** using high-pressure hot water and hospital-grade biodegradable bactericidal enzyme deodorizer.

Summer Preventative Wash Cycle

From June 1 to September 30, high-traffic pedestrian trash cans in Maplewood Village and Springfield Ave commercial districts undergo mandatory **weekly pressure-washing and disinfectant treatment** to prevent insect breeding.

COMMERCIAL RESTAURANT & BUSINESS DUMPSTER ENCLOSURES (§ 209-18)

Commercial food establishments and apartment buildings must keep dumpster lids securely closed at all times, maintain grease traps, ensure drain plugs are seated, and house containers within fully screened masonry corrals. Report overflowing or foul-smelling commercial dumpsters to the Health Department at **(973) 762-8120 Ext. 4200**.

Chapter 8: Household Hazardous Waste (HHW) & E-Waste Diversion

Certain household chemicals, automotive fluids, and consumer electronics contain toxic heavy metals or volatile organic compounds. Under New Jersey Department of Environmental Protection (NJDEP) regulations, **placing hazardous waste or electronics in curbside bins is strictly illegal**.

Essex County Household Hazardous Waste (HHW) Days

Maplewood partners with the **Essex County Utilities Authority (ECUA)** to host county-wide HHW collection days (Spring & Fall) at 125 Amherst Street, East Orange. Free for all Maplewood residents.

- Pesticides, herbicides, weed killers & fertilizers
- Oil-based paints, varnishes, mineral spirits & turpentine
- Automotive motor oil, antifreeze & car lead-acid batteries
- Pool chemicals, muriatic acid, mercury thermostats & propane tanks

Electronics Recycling (E-Waste) at 359 Boyden Ave

Under the *Electronic Waste Management Act*, manufacturers fund zero-cost recycling for covered electronic devices. Drop off at the DPW Depot (Mon–Fri 8 AM–3 PM, Sat 8 AM–12 PM):

- Televisions (flat-panel, CRT, projection) and computer monitors
- Desktop computers, towers, laptops, tablets, and e-readers
- Printers, scanners, fax machines, and computer peripherals
- Stereo equipment, DVD players, VCRs, gaming consoles & microwaves

CONFIDENTIAL DOCUMENT SHREDDING & TEXTILE DIVERSION PROGRAMS

Mobile Paper Shredding Events

The Township sponsors semi-annual confidential paper shredding events at Town Hall (Spring & Fall). Residents may bring up to **four (4) banker boxes** of confidential financial documents, medical files, or tax returns. On-site industrial shredder trucks destroy documents instantly.

Textile & Clothing Donation Bins

Dedicated charitable textile donation bins are located inside the 359 Boyden Avenue Recycling Yard. Residents can deposit bagged wearable clothing, shoes, belts, handbags, bed linens, towels, and curtains, diverting tons of fabric waste from the waste stream.

LATEX PAINT DISPOSAL PROTOCOL

Water-based (latex) paint is non-hazardous and **NOT accepted at HHW collection days**. Residents must remove the lid, add kitty litter or paint hardener until dry and solid, and place the opened can inside regular household garbage bins.

Chapter 9: The Maplewood Jitney Commuter Transit Service

The Department of Public Works operates the **Maplewood Commuter Jitney Shuttle Service**, connecting residential neighborhoods directly to the Maplewood NJ Transit Train Station for seamless Midtown Direct service to New York Penn Station and Hoboken.

JITNEY COMMUTER ROUTE	OPERATING CORRIDORS & PRIMARY PICK-UP POINTS	SCHEDULE & PEAK FREQUENCY
Parker Avenue Route	Originates at Boyden Ave / Parker Ave, servicing Orchard Rd, Prospect St, and Maplewood Station loop.	Mon–Fri Morning (6:00–9:00 AM) & Evening Peak (5:00–8:30 PM). Trains synchronized.
Elmwood Avenue Route	Servicing East Maplewood, Elmwood Ave, Tuscan Rd, Valley St, and direct to Maplewood Station.	Buses run every 15–20 minutes during morning and evening rush hours.
Wyoming / North Route	North Maplewood, Wyoming Ave corridor, Claremont Ave, Ridgewood Rd to Maplewood Station.	Full weekday commuter coverage. Real-time GPS tracking via mobile portal.

JITNEY FARES & PASS REGISTRATION: Annual Jitney Subscription Passes are **$95.00 per year** (discounted $50 for seniors/students) purchased online via GovPilot. Single-trip one-way tickets are $2.00 exact cash paid to driver.

Chapter 10: Departmental Directory & Sanitation Contacts

DEPARTMENT / MUNICIPAL OFFICE	TELEPHONE & EXTENSION	OFFICIAL EMAIL ADDRESS	OFFICE HOURS & LOCATION
DPW Main Office & Scale House	(973) 762-1175	publicworks@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:00 AM – 3:00 PM • 359 Boyden Ave
311 Citizen Service Desk & Dispatch	(555) 311-MAPL / 311	services311@maplewoodnj.gov	24/7 Digital Intake • Dispatch: (555) 123-7623
Division of Code Enforcement	(973) 762-8120 Ext. 3300	codeenforcement@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • Town Hall
Maplewood Division of Health	(973) 762-8120 Ext. 4200	healthdept@maplewoodnj.gov	Mon–Fri 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM • 574 Valley St
Maplewood Police Dispatch (Non-Emerg)	(973) 762-3400 / 911	police@maplewoodnj.gov	24 Hours / 7 Days • 161 Dunnell Rd
Essex County Utilities Authority (ECUA)	(973) 792-9060	info@ecuanj.com	Household Hazardous Waste Hotline

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